

Chapter 25-4

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The room was even darker than the living room, with only a small bedside night light on.

Still near the balcony area.

When she first entered, Liang Shi hadn't yet adjusted to the dimness inside the room and almost bumped her head against the wall.

Clearly, she wasn't the one who had been drinking, yet she felt somewhat dizzy and disoriented.

Xu Qingzhu was sleeping soundly, or rather, in a deep slumber.

The room was filled with the sound of steady breathing.

When she was asleep, she was extremely well-behaved, showing no trace of the evening's commotion.

Liang Shi sat by the bed for a while, then curled up in the corner sofa.

Being tall with long legs, curling up on the sofa was too cramped. She looked toward Xu Qingzhu in the dim light.

She really wanted to ask the system: Hey? Are you there? Arrange a bed for me.

Unfortunately, there was no response.

The system wouldn't bother with such trivial matters.

But for Liang Shi, this was a big deal.

She had always had requirements for sleep. Even when filming night scenes, she would definitely find time to sleep on a comfortable bed.

If there was no bed, she'd rather not sleep at all.

She couldn't sleep on the sofa, so she simply got up again. After going back and forth several times, she felt somewhat irritated.

After a moment, she turned on the dim yellow bedside lamp.

She pulled out a book from the bedside drawer - it was a poetry collection.

From the wear marks, it looked like it belonged to Xu Qingzhu.

The poetry collection was entirely in English. Liang Shi couldn't read much of it. Her English level was limited to oral communication, and even then, only simple conversations.

This was something her agent had arranged with foresight, thinking that she might go international someday. To prevent her from being mocked for lacking culture when accepting awards abroad, she had specifically hired a teacher to practice spoken English with her.

Liang Shi casually flipped through a few pages and put it back.

There wasn't much in the room for her to pass the time with, so she could only take out her phone, open a video app, and randomly clicked on a movie to watch.

She leaned against the headboard. The soft cushions were quite comfortable, relieving the fatigue from her busy day.

She piled all of the large double quilt on Xu Qingzhu's side. The bundled-up quilt clearly divided this bed with a boundary like the Chu River and Han Border¹. One side had someone sleeping soundly, the other side didn't even have room to turn over.

But having a place where Liang Shi could be slightly more comfortable meant she wouldn't be so irritated.

The movie was an old film. Liang Shi discovered that some of her favorite movies from her world also existed here, along with some new films she'd never heard of. The production of new films inevitably involved new stars, and Liang Shi didn't recognize any of these stars.

She clearly realized that this wasn't the entertainment industry of her world.

But being able to start over in a new place was still quite exciting.

Although she hadn't yet gotten her own body back, Liang Shi was already looking forward to entering the industry and acting.

After all, having lived for so many years, acting was what gave her the most sense of achievement and allowed her to realize her self-worth.

Thinking of this, she couldn't help but look toward Xu Qingzhu.

She thought to herself: How can I win you over?

The system's exact words were: gain her favor, trust, and adoration.

It was really a highly technical job.

Being able to achieve the first two points would already be difficult.

But still, as she'd said before, take it one step at a time.

Liang Shi never wasted today's time worrying excessively about tomorrow's affairs.

The movie was a same-sex film, set in the background before ABO gender differentiation.

The opening frame was white text on a black background - "Once, society wouldn't allow us to love."

The second line - "But we insisted on embracing tightly in crowds, kissing passionately."

Just these two lines stirred Liang Shi's emotions, and she lowered her eyelashes to watch quietly.

This movie told the story of two girls falling in love in college. One was a dance major, specializing in ballet, a typical campus goddess, bright and dazzling, the object of many male students' admiration. She participated in various competitions, winning awards left and right. Being the school beauty was her label.

The other female lead appeared plain and ordinary in comparison. She was timid and had low self-esteem. Although pretty, she didn't show her brilliance much, and because she didn't know how to dress up, she appeared rustic. On the first day of school, these two became roommates in the same dormitory.

The insecure one clumsily imitated the radiant one.

Wanting to become a second version of her, wanting to become popular like her.

But she was always on the periphery of groups. When the dormitory had gatherings, they left her behind. When everyone went traveling, they left her behind too.

They chatted about clothes, bags, and cosmetics, and she could only be a quiet observer.

Whenever she gathered courage to join the conversation, she would become a conversation killer. The previously cheerful atmosphere would suddenly cool down.

Gradually, she no longer inserted herself into these topics, becoming solitary.

And the one isolated along with her was the excellent radiant one.

Because she was too outstanding, she was seen as someone who loved showing off, incompatible with ordinary people, and would also become the target of everyone's dislike.

Their connection began with a song, because they both loved that song, so they had dinner together.

Gradually, their understanding of each other deepened. One was a dancer, the other could play elegant piano.

They developed a unique understanding between them. Going out, holding hands, linking arms, acting cute with each other. When they needed to do something, just one look from each other and they would understand.

The goddess rejected all her suitors, remaining single all along.

So there were rumors saying they were a couple, that the goddess didn't date because she had issues with her sexual orientation.

The rumors grew more intense. The insecure one took the initiative to distance herself, suppressing her inner feelings while feeling dejected during the day and unable to sleep at night, yet she couldn't help but care about her movements - who she had dinner with, how many classes she attended, what people she met.

This stiff relationship lasted for several months.

Until one day, on a bus, the goddess encountered sexual harassment. For the first time, the insecure one stood up so bravely. She stood on the moral high ground and severely condemned that person, and pulled her hand.

In that instant, their fingers interlocked.

That was the bravest moment of her life.

After getting off the bus, by the azure seaside, the insecure one gathered courage to ask, "May I kiss you?"

The movie reached its climax here. This was a restrained yet intimate kiss.

This movie's color palette was very comfortable. The kiss scene placed against such a background had a tragic feeling. The two female leads had different styles - one was the intense beauty type, the other was the pure type.

The pure one was tainted with unknown desires, kissing passionately and desperately.

While the seemingly intense one could only respond clumsily.

This kiss scene lasted two minutes, and the comments were going crazy.

Liang Shi found them distracting and turned off all the comments.

To say something mood-killing, she wasn't immersed in the emotions of the two protagonists, but was watching the camera work.

After all, as an actress, she knew how such kiss scenes were filmed.

Footnotes:

¹ Chu River and Han Border (楚河漢界) - Refers to the boundary lines on a Chinese chess board, metaphorically meaning a clear division or boundary between two sides.